SAN LORENZO UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT MEASURE J

J To renew expiring local school funding without increasing current tax rates; support academic excellence and programs in reading, writing, math, arts, science and technology; attract and retain highly qualified teachers and staff; and continue stable, local funding the State cannot take away; shall San Lorenzo Unified School District's measure be adopted, renewing its expiring $99 parcel tax for 12 years, providing approximately $1.8 million annually, with senior exemptions, citizen oversight, and no funds for district administrators?	**YES**
	NO

COUNTY COUNSEL'S IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE J

ANALYSIS BY THE COUNTY COUNSEL FOR THE COUNTY OF ALAMEDA OF A SAN LORENZO UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT SPECIAL PARCEL TAX MEASURE

Measure J ("Measure"), a San Lorenzo Unified School District ("District") special parcel tax measure, seeks voter approval to renew the District's expiring special parcel tax, beginning on July 1, 2027, maintaining the rate of $99 per parcel, for a period of twelve years.

The District estimates the parcel tax, if passed, will provide approximately $1,800,000 annually. The District will use the revenue only for the purposes listed in the Measure, which include, but are not limited to: supporting academic programs in reading, writing, math, arts, science and technology; preparing students for college and the workplace; and attracting and retaining highly qualified teachers and staff, including in high-need areas such as math, science, and special education.

In addition to properties otherwise exempt from property taxes, the following people may apply to the District for exemptions on residential parcels owned and occupied as a principal residence: persons 65 years or older; persons receiving Supplemental Security Income for a disability; and persons receiving Social Security Disability Insurance Benefits who meet specified income requirements.

The Measure contains certain accountability provisions, including requiring the District to deposit parcel tax proceeds in a separate account, produce an annual report to the District's governing board detailing the amount of funds collected and expended and the status of any projects funded by the proceeds, and conduct an annual financial audit by the District's governing board to ensure parcel tax proceeds are spent for educational purposes. The District's governing board will also appoint a citizen oversight committee to review the District's use of parcel tax proceeds to ensure that they are expended for the purposes listed in the Measure.

A school district has the authority to levy special taxes upon approval by two-thirds of the votes cast on the special tax proposal. (Cal. Const. art. XIII A, § 4; art. XIII C, § 2; Cal. Gov't Code §§ 50075-50077, 50079, & 53722.) If two-thirds of the qualified electors voting on this Measure do not vote for approval, it will fail, and the District will not be authorized to levy the special parcel tax.

This Measure is placed on the ballot by the governing board of the District.

s/ ANDREA L. WEDDLE
Interim County Counsel

The above statement is an impartial analysis of Measure J, which is printed in full in this sample ballot pamphlet. If you desire an additional copy of the measure, please call the Elections Official's office at (510) 272-6933 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you. You may also access the full text of the measure on the Alameda County website at the following address: www.acvote.org.

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE J

Measure J will prevent cuts to the quality education in our neighborhood schools.

For nearly a decade, San Lorenzo Unified has relied on locally controlled funding to support academic programs, retain its excellent teaching staff, and prepare students for college and careers. That funding expires this year unless voters renew it.

Measure J won't raise tax rates. It simply renews existing local funding at the current rate, continuing what voters have already approved.

Without Measure J, over $1,800,000 will need to be cut from the budget, forcing the layoff of 20 teachers, high staff turnover, and academic program reductions.

Measure J keeps stable funding in place—**without increasing tax rates—**so San Lorenzo students continue to have access to qualified teachers and academic programs that prepare them for college and beyond.

Even if you do not have school-age children, supporting quality education in local schools is a wise investment. Good schools improve the quality of life in our community and protect the value of our homes.

Your YES Vote Helps Prevent Cuts and Protect Core Academics

- Prepare students for college and the workplace
- Support academic programs in reading, writing, math, arts, science and technology
- Attract and retain highly qualified teachers and staff
- Attract teachers in shortage areas such as special education, math and science

Measure J Is Fiscally Accountable

- All funds stay in San Lorenzo schools, and no funds can be taken by the State
- An independent Citizens' Oversight Committee and annual audits ensure funds are spent as promised
- Homeowners 65 or older and low-income individuals with disabilities that qualify for federal SSI or SSDI are eligible for exemptions

Our students deserve the same opportunities as others in our region. Measure J will prevent cuts and protect the academic programs that our students need to succeed. Vote Yes on J!

s/PENNY PECK
Former SLZUSD Board Member

s/ROBERT GLAZE
Local Business Owner

s/SANDRA VINCENT
40-Year Local Resident

s/AISHA KNOWLES
Community Member

NO ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE J WAS SUBMITTED

FULL TEXT OF MEASURE J

SAN LORENZO UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT SAN LORENZO EXCELLENCE IN EDUCATION ACT OF 2026

To renew expiring local school funding without increasing current tax rates; support academic excellence and programs in reading, writing, math, arts, science and technology; attract and retain highly qualified teachers and staff; and continue stable, local funding the State cannot take away; shall San Lorenzo Unified School District's measure be adopted, renewing its expiring $99 parcel tax for 12 years, providing approximately $1.8 million annually, with senior exemptions, citizen oversight, and no funds for district administrators?

Moneys raised under this Measure shall be authorized to be used only for the following purposes in accordance with priorities established by the Board and to the extent of available funds:

- To prepare students for college and the workplace
- To support academic programs in reading and writing
- To support academic programs in math, arts, science, and technology
- To attract and retain highly qualified teachers and staff
- To attract and retain teachers in high-need areas such as special education, math, and science

No funds will be spent on administrators.

A. Amount and Basis of Tax

This qualified special tax shall authorize the District to annually levy a special tax of $99 per Parcel of Taxable Real Property beginning July 1, 2027, and continuing for a period of twelve (12) years.

This qualified special tax is estimated to raise $1,800,000 in annual local funding for District schools. The amount of annual local funding raised by this qualified special tax will vary from year-to-year due to changes in the number of parcels subject to the levy.

"Parcel of Taxable Real Property" is defined as any unit of real property in the District that receives a separate tax bill for *ad valorem* property taxes from the County Tax Collector's Office. All property that is otherwise exempt from or upon which no *ad valorem* property taxes are levied in any year shall also be exempt from the special tax in such year.

B. Exemptions

Under procedures adopted by the District, an exemption from payment of the special tax may be granted on any parcel owned by one or more persons who is/are:

1. An individual who will attain 65 years of age prior to July 1 of the tax year and occupying said parcel as his or her principal residence ("Senior Citizen Exemption"); or,
2. Receiving Supplemental Security Income for a disability, regardless of age, and occupying said parcel as his or her principal residence ("SSI Exemption"); or
3. Receiving Social Security Disability Insurance benefits, regardless of age, whose yearly income does not exceed 250 percent of the 2012 federal poverty guidelines issued by the United States Department of Health and Human Services, and occupying said parcel as his or her principal residence ("SSDI Exemption").

The District shall annually provide to the Alameda County Tax Collector ("County Tax Collector") or other appropriate County officials a list of parcels that the District has approved for an exemption.

C. Claims / Exemption Procedures

With respect to all general property tax matters within its jurisdiction, the County Tax Collector or other appropriate County tax official shall make all final determinations of tax exemption or relief for any reason, and that decision shall be final and binding. With respect to matters specific to the levy of the special tax including any exemptions, the application of the definition of "Parcel of Taxable Real Property" to any parcel(s), the legality or validity of the special tax, or any other disputed matter specific to the application of the special tax, the decisions of the District shall be final and binding. The procedures described herein, and any additional procedures established by the Board shall be the exclusive claims procedure for claimants seeking an exemption, refund, reduction, or re-computation of the special tax. Whether any particular claim is to be resolved by the District or by the County shall be determined by the District, in coordination with the County as necessary.

D. Appropriations Limit

Pursuant to California Constitution Article XIIIB and applicable laws, the appropriations limit for the District will be adjusted periodically by the aggregate sum collected by levy of this qualified special tax.

E. Mandatory Accountability Protections

1. *Specific Purposes.* The proceeds of the special tax shall be applied only to the specific purposes identified above. The proceeds of the special tax shall be deposited into a fund, which shall be kept separate and apart from other funds of the District.

2. *Annual Reports.* No later than December 31 of each year while the tax is in effect, the District shall prepare and file with the Board a report detailing the amount of funds collected and expended, and the status of any project authorized to be funded by this Measure. The report may relate to the calendar year, fiscal year, or other appropriate annual period, and may be incorporated into or filed with the annual budget, audit, or other appropriate routine report to the Board.

3. *Independent Citizens' Oversight Committee.* The Board shall provide for the creation of an independent citizens' oversight committee to oversee expenditure of the funds collected pursuant to the Measure to ensure that moneys raised under this Measure are spent only for the purposes described in this Measure. The Board shall provide for the composition, duties, and other necessary information regarding the committee's formation and operation.

F. Protection of Funding

Current law forbids any decrease in State or federal funding to the District resulting from the adoption of qualified special tax. However, if any such funding is reduced or affected because of the adoption of this local funding measure, then the Board may reduce the amount of the special taxes levied as necessary in order to restore such State or federal funding and/or maximize the District's fiscal position for the benefit of the educational program. As a result, whether directly or indirectly, no funding from this measure may be taken away by the State or federal governments.

G. Severability

The Board hereby declares, and the voters by approving this Measure concur, that every section and part of this Measure has independent value, and the Board and the voters would have adopted each provision hereof regardless of every other provision hereof. Upon approval of this Measure by the voters, should any part of the Measure or taxing formula be found by a court of competent jurisdiction to be invalid for any reason, all remaining parts of the Measure or taxing formula hereof shall remain in full force and effect to the fullest extent allowed by law.